

Jarrold Tran

HEAD OF STRATEGIC PLANNING AND SPECIAL PROJECTS — MEGAPACK

Houston, TX

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PLANNING · SPECIAL PROJECTS · FACTORY AI

TESLA · APPLE · WAYMO · AMAZON

I take messy operating problems—capacity, launches, factory AI—and stay with them until there's a plan a factory can run. Currently Head of Strategic Planning and Special Projects for Tesla Energy Megapack; previously Apple iPhone, Waymo, and Amazon.

3.2× PRODUCTION SCALE	\$260M ANNUALIZED SAVINGS	\$156M INCREMENTAL PROFIT	293% YOY UNIT GROWTH
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Tesla Head of Strategic Planning and Special Projects — Megapack · Houston, TX

MAR 2026 – PRESENT

- Lead operating strategy and special projects for Tesla Energy's Megapack work, including the Houston Megafactory ramp and how we use AI on the floor.

Tesla Staff Industrial Engineer → Manager, Technical Programs — Energy Manufacturing · Lathrop, CA

AUG 2023 – MAR 2026

- Ran a 30+ person team across NPI, industrial engineering, and production planning for Megapack.
- Scaled global capacity 3.2× (14.7 to 46.7 GWh) and generated \$156M in incremental annual profit by putting \$23M across 50+ capacity initiatives.
- Delivered \$260M in annualized savings through a 12-month NPI cost-down across materials, labor, and supplier contracts.
- Used Python and Tableau models on capacity, labor, automation, and footprint; 56% more capacity and 26% lower unit cost.
- Took about \$550M in projected tariff exposure off the table by redesigning build plans and standing up FTZ, bonded-warehouse, and product-changeover infrastructure.

Waymo Strategy & BizOps Manager — Engineering · Mountain View, CA

OCT 2022 – MAY 2023

- Set up annual planning, OKRs, resource plans, and quarterly reviews for Engineering Operations.
- Pulled hardware, software, fleet, Product, Legal, and Engineering onto shared milestones so leadership could see bottlenecks without chasing updates.

Apple Senior Strategic Operations Program Manager — iPhone · Cupertino, CA

JUN 2021 – JUN 2022

- Launched iPhone manufacturing in India from site and supplier qualification through line readiness and mass production.
- Units grew 293% year over year (4.3M to 16.9M). Revenue went from \$2B to \$10B. Exports went from 6 countries to more than 40.

Tesla Program Manager, Special Projects · Fremont, CA

JUN 2018 – JUN 2021

- Took Project Roadrunner from an early 4680 pilot to a production-ready platform in time for Battery Day.
- Led production planning and vehicle operations across Fremont shops, sustaining Model 3 / Model Y rates through demand surges and supply disruptions.
- Designed and launched a \$3.5M/month mobile logistics platform to protect battery and drivetrain flow during factory scale-up.

Amazon Operations Area Manager · Patterson, CA

MAR 2017 – MAY 2018

- Led 100+ associates in a fulfillment center and used Lean methods to hold KPIs on a high-volume shift.

EDUCATION

University at Buffalo

B.S. Business Administration, Finance · Cum Laude